

Ten Years of SAP, and What Odoo Taught Me in a Week

A short account of the journey behind this pitch — for whoever's curious after the meeting

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I want to leave you with something shorter and more personal than the package itself — not another proof point, just the honest account of how I got here, in case it's useful to whoever is deciding whether I'm a good bet for your team.

Where the discipline came from

I never studied computer science. I built my way into enterprise software from the ground up — running a Shell forecourt through college, running a warehouse's WMS and its returns queue by hand, teaching myself SQL to keep an e-commerce site alive — and then ten years inside the SAP ecosystem: C4/HANA, Hybris, Cloud for Customer, Sales and Service Cloud, most recently CRM architecture at enterprise scale. What that decade actually taught me wasn't a product. It was a **lifecycle** — blueprint, workshop, functional spec, build, UAT, hypercare — and a rule that survives any platform: nothing you show a client is real until you've tried to break it yourself first.

What this case study actually taught me about Odoo

I had never configured Odoo before this brief. What I found, learning it under deadline, surprised me: it isn't a lesser SAP — it's a different bet entirely. SAP separates and specialises; Odoo unifies one data model and lets automation rules carry the compliance logic that SAP would spread across modules and middleware. For a mid-market regulated manufacturer, that unification is the whole value proposition — I could build a real GxP-aware compliant thread, four enforced controls, and full UDI traceability in days, on a platform that costs a fraction of the enterprise suites I spent a decade implementing. That's not a knock on SAP; it's a precise answer to *which client needs which tool*, which is the question a decade of SAP work actually trains you to ask.

How I worked, and why it looked the way it did

I used modern AI tooling the way I'd use any junior resource on a real engagement: as leverage under direction, never as a replacement for judgement. The habit that decade of SAP delivery drilled into me — verify everything against the running system, never ship what you haven't tested yourself — is the same habit that produced the correction log, the live regression pass, and the peer review sitting in this package. Multiple passes, adversarial re-reads, a boardroom teardown I ran on myself before anyone else could. That wasn't process for its own sake. It's simply how I was trained to work, applied to a new platform under a tight clock.

What I learned about much.

I read your MedTech page closely enough to notice what it doesn't yet say about the UK's 2025–26 device reforms, and I found your Managing Partner's own conference talk before I ever met anyone from your team — not to flatter it back to you, but because understanding a firm's actual published thinking is the same discovery discipline I'd bring to a client engagement. What came through in that research, and in the case brief itself, is a business that would rather say "here's what we don't know yet" than oversell a capability — which is exactly the instinct this whole package was built around. That's not a coincidence I'm pointing out to flatter you; it's the reason I think I'd fit here without having to unlearn anything.

THE HONEST SUMMARY

I didn't come into this case study as an Odoo expert, and I'm not going to pretend otherwise. I came in as someone who has spent a decade learning that the platform is never really the hard part — the discipline is. This week was proof, to myself as much as to you, that the discipline travels. That's what I'd bring to your team on day one, on whichever platform your next client happens to be running.